



Russell Dudek

OPERATIONS PROCESS EXCELLENCE DIRECTOR CANDIDATE

Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania
412.287.8640 · russelldudek@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/russelldudek
Candidate vision

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Hiring Team
NWN

NWN is not hiring this director to run a generic continuous-improvement program. The company is asking someone to build Operations Process Excellence from the ground up, own the Opportunity-to-Cash roadmap and KPI framework, govern change and training, and establish the readiness gate every new offering must clear before it can be transacted. The real mandate is to let NWN grow faster without exporting commercial complexity into order errors, billing defects, unbilled inventory, margin leakage, and recurring exceptions.

That is why my thesis for the role is: make growth transactable before it enters the engine. A launch should not be considered ready because the offer is compelling or the target date arrived. Commercial definition, margin logic, transaction path, finance treatment, system configuration, operating ownership, SOPs, and training must reconcile before release. Process excellence then becomes a growth-control system—not an after-the-fact cleanup team.

I have spent my career inside the work such a system must improve. At Vape-Jet, I lead AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, Odoo/ERP, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, training, and accountability. At Amazon, I built operating routines, throughput visibility, escalation paths, labor-planning mechanisms, and standard work in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually. At Compunetics, I led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and high-reliability technical programs, building process controls, performance measures, and root-cause practices.

The obvious concern is that I have not previously held a formal enterprise O2C transformation title or owned NWN's exact NetSuite, ServiceNow, Salesforce, and revenue-recognition environment. That concern is fair. I would not substitute adjacent experience for the expertise of Finance, Sales Operations, IT, PMO, and frontline process owners. My case is that I know how to enter a complex operating system with humility, expose the real handoffs and decision rights, connect data to action, build mechanisms people can operate, and transfer ownership rather than create dependency.

I made that reasoning inspectable in an independent candidate vision at russelldudek.github.io/nwn/. It includes an interactive O2C Readiness Airlock, a 120-day entry plan, and the evidence boundaries behind the proposal. It is an outside-in hypothesis for discovery, not a claim about NWN's internal architecture.

I would welcome a conversation about where NWN's commercial promise most often loses fidelity across the transaction, what the readiness gate must have authority to stop, and what must be visibly different after twelve months for OPE to be considered indispensable.

Carpe diem,
Russell Dudek